

PANDI PERUMAL

Technical Project Manager | Agile Delivery Leader | PMP | SAFe Agilist | ICP-ACC

Digital Payments | Prepaid Card Platforms | Banking Technology

Chennai, India • pandiperumal75@yahoo.com • 984015691 • linkedin.com/in/pandi-perumal-93a2a1a2

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Technical Project Manager and PMP-certified delivery leader with 10 years of relevant experience and overall 15 years experience in digital payments and banking platforms — including cross-functional programs across both Waterfall and Agile delivery models. Proven ability to govern multi-million-dollar budgets, manage distributed teams of 25+, and drive delivery predictability from 65% to 95%. Combines deep technical fluency in .NET, SQL, cloud, and DevOps with strong program governance expertise: RAID management, change control, EVM, scope baselines, and stakeholder reporting. Recognized for bridging engineering and business strategy — translating complex technical work into executive-level visibility while enabling teams to deliver high-quality outcomes consistently.

KEY CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- **Improved release predictability from 65% → 95% through Agile governance, delivery cadence, and flow metrics (lead time, cycle time, throughput)**
- **Reduced critical production defects by 40% by embedding QA into delivery workflows via Definition of Done and continuous validation**
- **Cut lead time by 15% through WIP limiting, backlog readiness discipline, and Lean value stream optimization**
- **Reduced cycle time by 30% by removing systemic impediments and streamlining end-to-end delivery workflows**
- **Delivered application performance improvements via SQL schema redesign, indexing, and query optimization**
- **Managed hybrid budgets across Fixed Price and T&M contracts — WBS-based baselines for FP, burn rate & cap governance for T&M — with earned value tracking and formal change control**

TECHNICAL PROJECT MANAGER STRENGTHS

- **Dual-Mode Delivery Leadership:** Equally proficient in Waterfall (WBS, CPM, EVM, Gantt, RAID logs, stage-gate governance) and Agile (SAFe, Scrum, Kanban, PI Planning, flow-based forecasting) — adapts methodology to project complexity and stakeholder context.
- **Technical Depth:** 8+ years as developer and tech lead in .NET, SQL Server, and banking middleware — enables meaningful conversations with architects, DevOps engineers, and platform teams; reviews technical risks with credibility.
- **Cloud & Data Platform Awareness:** Hands-on exposure to Azure (AKS, Azure Data Factory, Azure DevOps), Databricks, Snowflake, Docker/Kubernetes, CI/CD pipelines, and microservices migration patterns (Debezium CDC, Apache Kafka) — bridges technical delivery and project governance across cloud-native and data engineering programs.
- **Budget & Financial Governance:** Manages Fixed Price (FP) and Time & Material (T&M) contracts — develops WBS-based cost baselines for FP engagements with locked scope and contingency reserves; applies T&M controls with burn rate monitoring, cap management, and scope change governance. Monitors cost variance (CV), CPI/SPI, and drives budget approvals through CAB and steering committee governance.
- **Risk & Dependency Management:** Maintains structured RAID logs, conducts risk response planning (avoid/transfer/mitigate/accept), and proactively manages cross-team dependencies across distributed squads.
- **Stakeholder & Executive Reporting:** Designs data-driven dashboards and governance reports providing real-time delivery visibility to senior leadership, steering committees, and client stakeholders.
- **AI-Augmented Delivery:** Leverages Generative AI tools (ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot) for project planning acceleration, automated risk summarization, sprint reporting, and delivery forecasting — quantifiably improving PM efficiency.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Project Management & Governance	Agile & Delivery Leadership	Technology & Payments Domain
▪ Project Lifecycle Management (Waterfall & Agile) ▪ WBS, CPM, Gantt & Schedule Management ▪ Earned Value Management (EVM) ▪ Budget & Cost Management ▪ Scope Management & Change Control ▪ RAID Log Management ▪ Risk Response Planning ▪ Stage-Gate & Milestone Governance ▪ Resource Planning & Capacity Management ▪ Fixed Price & T&M Contract Management ▪ Vendor & Contract Management ▪ Stakeholder Influence & Reporting	▪ SAFe 6.0 / PI Planning ▪ Scrum & Kanban ▪ Backlog Strategy & Readiness ▪ Agile Metrics & Forecasting ▪ Release & Dependency Management ▪ OKR Alignment ▪ Communities of Practice ▪ Agile Coaching & Transformation ▪ Value Stream Mapping ▪ DevOps & CI/CD Collaboration	▪ .NET & Microservices Architecture ▪ SQL Server, Oracle & Performance Tuning ▪ Azure (AKS, ADF, Azure DevOps, ACR) ▪ Docker & Kubernetes ▪ Debezium CDC & Apache Kafka ▪ Azure Databricks & Snowflake ▪ ISO 8583 / SWIFT ISO 20022 ▪ Prepaid Card & Core Banking Systems ▪ PCI DSS Compliance ▪ Generative AI (ChatGPT, Copilot) ▪ JIRA, Rally, Miro, Confluence ▪ Jenkins, Bitbucket, Terraform

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Project Manager / Agile Coach / Lead Scrum Master

Apr 2021 – Feb 2026

FIS Global — Chennai, India | Digital Payments & Prepaid Card Platform

Project & Program Delivery Leadership

- Led end-to-end delivery lifecycle (initiation through closure) for platform programs using Waterfall/hybrid methodologies; identified and mitigated program risks proactively while aligning cross-functional stakeholders — business, engineering, compliance — on scope, priorities, and change decisions.
- Managed program schedules in MS Project and Azure DevOps, applying Critical Path Method (CPM) and schedule variance analysis to protect milestones; resolved resource and priority conflicts across squads and third-party vendors through structured trade-off negotiation and recovery planning.
- Governed WBS-based cost baselines for Fixed Price engagements and burn-rate/cap controls for T&M contracts; managed budget and scope risk through formal change control, negotiating cost-scope-timeline trade-offs with stakeholders and steering committees.
- Facilitated lessons-learned and post-implementation reviews with cross-functional teams, identifying systemic risk patterns and delivery conflicts, and institutionalizing findings as process improvements adopted across future programs.
- Delivered executive-level risk dashboards and escalation briefings, translating technical and delivery risk into business impact for senior leadership; managed stakeholder expectations and resolved conflicting priorities across 3 concurrent digital product workstreams.
- Partnered with architecture and engineering teams across the SDLC for enterprise web application delivery — resolving design trade-offs between technical and business stakeholders, managing integration risk, and driving alignment on scalability and platform standards.

Agile & Program Delivery

- Led end-to-end Agile delivery for a portfolio of FIS prepaid card products across 3 Scrum teams (25+ members), resolving cross-team conflicts and aligning competing priorities to improve release predictability from **65% to 95%**.
- Forecasted sprint costs using story points, historical velocity, and management reserve; negotiated budget burn and variance trade-offs with steering committees on a bi-weekly cadence to keep delivery within approved guardrails.

- Identified and mitigated program-level risks and cross-team dependencies, resolving scope conflicts through formal change control — minimizing delivery delays and stakeholder escalations.
- Partnered with Product Owners to resolve backlog prioritization conflicts and align stakeholders on trade-offs, driving backlog readiness and acceptance criteria quality that delivered a **30% cycle time reduction**.
- Reduced critical production defects by **40%** by resolving quality-vs-speed conflicts between delivery and QA teams — embedding Definition of Done and continuous validation into the delivery workflow.
- Built Jira-based delivery and risk dashboards, proactively surfacing delivery risk to stakeholders and audit teams and enabling early conflict resolution before issues escalated.
- Governed risk and stakeholder alignment across a monolith-to-microservices migration on Azure (Debezium CDC, Apache Kafka, Azure Data Factory, Databricks, Snowflake) — resolving technical and priority conflicts across platform, data, and infrastructure squads to keep the program on track.
- Applied working knowledge of **SQL Server and Oracle** to assess data and integration risk for large-scale prepaid card and core banking applications — bridging technical and business stakeholders and resolving conflicting requirements between engineering and product teams.
- Aligned squad delivery goals to business OKRs, facilitating quarterly objective-setting with product leadership and resolving conflicting departmental priorities; tracked key results and reported OKR progress in steering committee reviews.
- Leveraged AI tools (ChatGPT, Copilot) for risk summarization, stakeholder reporting, and delivery forecasting — accelerating risk identification and freeing time for higher-value stakeholder and conflict management.

Product Owner (SAFe)

Apr 2020 – Mar 2021

FIS Global — Chennai, India

- Owned and prioritized the product backlog for FIS prepaid card platform, aligning features with business strategy, customer value, and technical feasibility.
- Translated stakeholder requirements into well-defined user stories with acceptance criteria; led backlog refinement, sprint planning, and sprint review ceremonies.
- Collaborated with architects and engineering teams to evaluate build vs. buy decisions and assess technical dependencies on the product roadmap.
- Validated delivered features through sprint reviews and UAT cycles; monitored release readiness against the Definition of Done.

Project Manager / Scrum Master (SAFe)

Apr 2015 – Mar 2020

FIS Global — Chennai, India

- Managed 2–3 Agile squads (8–10 members each) delivering digital payments and core banking features; improved release predictability from ~60% to ~90%.
- Owned project plans, risk logs, and stakeholder communication; reported project status and escalated issues to program managers and business sponsors.
- Partnered with Architecture and DevOps teams to enable CI/CD adoption, automated testing pipelines, and faster release cycles.
- Introduced data-driven delivery metrics (velocity trends, sprint goal success rate, defect leakage) — enabling informed planning and stakeholder confidence.
- Facilitated structured retrospectives with measurable action items, improving team efficiency and reducing recurring delivery issues.

Technical Lead – Application Development

Apr 2011 – Mar 2015

FIS Global — Chennai, India

- Architected and led development of .NET-based online and batch applications for prepaid card and banking platforms.
- Designed SQL Server schemas, stored procedures, and indexes; performed advanced query optimization and execution plan analysis — significantly reducing response times.
- Owned coding standards, technical governance, and application architecture for a team of 6 developers.
- Managed technical debt reduction, system modernization, and CI/CD pipeline integration with DevOps teams.

Senior Programmer – Application Development

Feb 2007 – Mar 2011

FIS Global — Chennai, India

- Developed and maintained prepaid banking application features including online modules, batch jobs, and backend services.
- Supported application migrations, production deployments, and post-release support across multiple release cycles.
- Analysed and resolved application defects and enhancement requests across development and testing phases.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Project Management Professional (PMP) — PMI
- Certified Scrum Master (CSM) — Scrum Alliance
- ICP-ACC Agile Coach — ICAgile
- SAFe Agilist (SA) — Scaled Agile Inc.
- SAFe Scrum Master (SSM) — Scaled Agile Inc.

EDUCATION

- Executive MBA — Cloud Computing & AI, NIBM Global, Chennai
- MBA in Project Management, Alagappa University, Karaikudi
- M.Sc. in Information Technology, Annamalai University, Chidambaram
- B.Com, Madurai Kamaraj University, Madurai

PERSONAL DETAILS

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/pandi-perumal-93a2a1a2/>